

Leapstart After School Care Center: Employee Training Manual

Welcome to the Leapstart team! This manual is your compass, guiding you through our core standards and best practices that define our commitment to children. We've crafted it to ensure every child in our care experiences safety, engagement, and enrichment. We expect you to study it carefully and understand its ethos comprehensively. Beyond just a guide, it's a living document. We invite each and every one of you to enrich it with insights from your own experiences.

For clarity and action, we've structured this guide around "Dos and Don'ts." This clarity ensures that we all sail in the same direction, consistently delighting the families we serve and upholding the Leapstart promise of safety, engagement, and enrichment.

Providing Safe Environment for children:

- Do prioritize child safety and well-being above all.
- Always prioritize the needs and well-being of the children. Ensure that your decisions and actions align with what's best for them.
- Don't engage in any behavior that might be perceived as inappropriate or unprofessional.
- Don't yell at kids, or show anger under any circumstances.
- Do ensure all unused electrical sockets in rooms assigned to you are blocked.
- Do familiarize yourself with Leapstart's emergency protocols. Whether it's a medical emergency, a natural disaster, or any other unexpected event, know the steps to take to ensure everyone's safety.
- Do always be watching out for safety. Regularly check the classroom and common areas for potential hazards.

Dealing with Diverse Student Needs:

- Do approach hyperactive or challenging children with patience and understanding.
- Do employ strategies to engage all children in activities, ensuring they feel included and happy.
- Do take notes on individual children who excel in certain areas, recognizing their achievements.

Classroom Management:

- Do have a designated lost and found area for parents during pickup and be aware of property belonging to kids assigned to you.
- Do maintain an updated notice board with relevant information for parents of kids assigned to you at the time of pickup.
- Do use radio sets for communication, especially during busy pickup hours.
- Do utilize loudspeakers for announcements and hands-free headset mics for classes that require movement.
- Don't raise your voice; instead, use the tools provided to gain attention while communicating with anyone at the center including children.
- Do keep the environment clean and organized.
- Do use all Leapstart resources judiciously. This includes teaching aids, digital tools, and physical supplies. Report any damages or shortages promptly.

Using Brightwheel:

- Do provide timely and accurate activity stamps for kids assigned to you.
- Do maintain accurate student profiles, including name, age, DOB, and grade.
- Do utilize the platform for lunch, homework, academic work, enrichment classes, heritage classes, vendor classes, and "great job" stamps.
- Do keep track of parents' notes for teachers on Brightwheel.

Sharing Kids' Pictures:

- Do capture moments when children are engaged, happy, and clear.
- Don't stage photos; let moments be genuine.
- Don't overdo it. Few times a week is enough.
- Don't publish pictures for the sake of it. Only if you truly feel the kids are captivated in an interesting activity they are enjoying.
- Do publish individual kid's picture if they are delighted about a learning activity.

Curriculum Maintenance:

- Do ensure that the curriculum you are following is progressive and engaging for kids assigned to you.
- Do ensure that all curriculum aligns with Leapstart's educational philosophy and goals.
- Do maintain an updated curriculum for all classes Leapstart offers.

Communication:

- Do communicate respectfully with everyone.
- Do provide feedback and updates to parents about their child's progress and achievements thru Brightwheel or at the time of Pickup.

Health and Safety:

- Do keep your CPR and First Aid certifications active.
- Do familiarize yourself with the location of first aid kits and emergency exits.

Breaks and Work Hours:

- Do take your designated 15-minute tea breaks.
- Do ensure you take a 30-minute unpaid break for every 5 hours worked. Plan for it in advance.

Professional Code of Conduct:

- Don't gossip about children, colleagues, or parents with anyone at Leapstart.
- Do communicate openly and respectfully with colleagues, children, and parents.
- Don't share any confidential information about the children, their families, or fellow staff members.
- Do be proactive in seeking feedback from your seniors and management and continuously improving your teaching methods.
- Do read the company's handbook shared with you on Zenefits to familiarize yourself with all Leapstart policies and procedures, ensuring compliance at all times.
- Do practice Cultural Sensitivity: Be aware of the diverse backgrounds of our students. Celebrate this diversity and ensure that all children feel respected and understood.
- Do address any conflicts, whether with colleagues, parents, or students, promptly and professionally. Seek mediation or guidance from senior staff if necessary.
- Do ensure that all activities, lessons, and breaks are conducted within the stipulated time. This helps maintain a routine that children can rely on.

Practice Kaizen (Continuous Improvement):

- Do participate in ongoing training and professional development opportunities.

- Do collaborate with colleagues, sharing insights and strategies for classroom management and child engagement.
- Do create Feedback Loop: Regularly solicit feedback from children, parents, and colleagues. Use this feedback constructively to refine your approach and methods.
- Do seek new and engaging ways to deliver lessons and activities on a regular basis. A dynamic approach keeps children interested and eager to learn. Take help from Google on how to lead effectively with children under your care.

Conclusion:

Thank you for being an integral part of the Leapstart team. Our collective success hinges on the dedication, passion, and insights each one of you brings to the table. As you navigate your journey with us, remember that this manual is not just a set of guidelines, but a reflection of our shared commitment to excellence. Together, let's continue to create an environment where every child thrives, and every family feels valued. Here's to many shared successes and the bright future of Leapstart!